
No Contact in Shared Circles

Keeping your boundaries with mutual friends and at work

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No contact is simplest when you never have to see your ex. Real life isn't always like that. You might share a friend group, a gym, a class or an office. You can still protect your recovery. It just looks more like "low contact with firm boundaries" than total silence.

With mutual friends

- Tell close friends you're doing no contact and ask them not to pass on news about your ex.
- Don't ask them for updates, either. It's contact by proxy.
- Don't make friends choose sides. It usually backfires.
- Plan one-on-one time with friends so you're not only seeing them at group events.
- It's okay to skip some events for now. You don't have to explain in detail.

What to say to friends

- "I'm taking some space from ___ for a while. Could you not tell me what they're up to? It helps me move on."
- "I'd love to come, but I'm not ready to be around them yet. Can we get lunch next week instead?"

At work

Keep interactions professional, polite and brief. Stick to work channels and work topics. If you need to work together, focus on the task and keep any personal conversation off the table. If the situation is affecting your work or feels hostile, it's reasonable to speak to a manager or HR confidentially.

When you see them

1. Decide your script in advance: a nod, a "hi", and move on.
2. Have an exit plan and a friend you can stand with.
3. Limit alcohol at shared events. It lowers your guard.
4. Afterwards, don't check their profile. Write down how it went instead.

Social anxiety about running into them

Worrying about seeing your ex can feel worse than actually seeing them. Rehearse the moment once, calmly, in your head or on paper, then let it go. Most encounters are over in seconds, and each one gets easier.

YOUR NOTES

What I'm taking from this guide

NEXT STEP

Put it into practice for 30 days.

The No-Contact Journal is a printable 30-day guided journal: 90 prompts, a daily no-contact check-in, and a "Before you text them" page for the moments you're about to reach out.

Get it at digitaldisconnect.shop

Or start free with the 3-day starter at digitaldisconnect.shop/free

This guide is general self-help information, not therapy, medical or legal advice. If you're thinking about harming yourself, in the US call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or contact your local emergency number.

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